THE BLACK LIST

THIS IS BAT COUNTRY - "DRUNK"

Kerry Ann Burke

Professional Evaluation #1

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Overall	Premise	Plot	Character	Dialogue	Setting
7/10	7/10	7/10	7/10	7/10	7/10

Genre

Supernatural Thriller, Gothic Horror, Mystery & Suspense, Horror, Crime Thriller

Logline

A murdered young woman is turned into a vampire against her will by a haunted vampire with a vendetta who ropes her into helping him tracking down her killer and his original maker.

Strengths

Though there have been so many stories centering on different kinds of vampires from TRUE BLOOD to VAMPIRE DIARIES to TWILIGHT, but there's something about THIS IS BAT COUNTRY that feels like it's paying homage to the vampire genre while also being its own thing. Pants and Caleb (and the voice in Caleb's head, which is referred to as "Dutch Angle") make for quite an interesting pair, as the two seem like such opposites but actually complement each other quite well. Though Caleb is clearly shown to make a spur of the moment decision to ultimately "save" Pants and turn her into a vampire, it is clear that he does actually care about Pants and wants to keep her safe. Two constantly bicker, but by the end of the pilot, it's clear that the they have bonded. With Detectives Wilcox and Ritter on their tail, there's a fun cat-and-mouse aspect to this story as well, with Caleb trying to figure out who Pants' murderer is (with suspicions that her murderer is supernatural) and also discover how he was turned into a vampire himself while Wilcox and Ritter try to figure out why Pants' body has gone missing and who Caleb exactly is. All in all, it makes for a pilot that's incredibly riveting with high stakes and an electrifying energy.

Weaknesses

While the pilot is quite strong overall, with a lot of mystery and suspense and emotional stakes really driving the story, there are some ways that the writer can make this pilot truly exceptional. While the pilot is mainly focused on Caleb and what he's gone through in his time as a vampire and his struggles with trying to track down this serial killer (and ultimately, his maker), there could be more of a focus on Pants, especially with what she's leaving behind in her old life. With Pants clearly defying Caleb's instructions and going back to her old apartment, it is clear that Pants misses her old life. Who is she leaving behind? How did she end up becoming a blackjack dealer in training in Las Vegas? Who is Jane, the person who texts Pants asking where she is? Even in terms of Caleb, it is curious that the only vampire that he seems to have a relationship with is

Angelina. Who has he left behind? What kind of impact has his "death" had? All in all, while not all of this necessarily needs to all be explored in the pilot, these are questions that the writer might want to think about in the process of turning this pilot into a full-fledged television series, especially one with the stakes to be an ongoing show.

Prospects

As previously stated, there have been so many vampire television series in the past including TRUE BLOOD, VAMPIRE DIARIES and INTERVIEW WITH THE VAMPIRE. There is clearly always going to be a niche audience for vampires, as there is something so inherently romantic about vampires' thirst for blood and immortality. That being said, THIS IS BAT COUNTRY does something a little different for the genre, clearly paying homage to the vampire stories that have before it while also feeling more like FARGO and TRUE DETECTIVE with the added mystery and thriller elements. It is exactly the kind of smart, humorously dark and inventive show that premium networks like AMC, FX and maybe even Apple TV+ are looking for, and both Pants and Caleb feel very castable, which will also help the show's chances. Though the pilot doesn't exactly feel like it has an ongoing series engine, with Pants' and Caleb's stories seemingly having a clear conclusion with Pants discovering who killed her and Caleb finding his maker, there is a chance for this world to become a franchise with several different characters and stories in the same universe, since this is an original vampire story with its own rules, similar to what THE WALKING DEAD did with zombies.